

Nielsen Norman Group **Heuristic Evaluation Workbook**

Use this workbook to conduct your own heuristic evaluation.

For each of Jakob's 10 Usability Heuristics, look for specific places where the interface fails to adhere to the guideline. Write your recommendations for how to fix those usability issues.

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Evaluator:
johnjake
Date:
Product:
Task

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

- No loading indicator when processing actions
- No confirmation after saving or submitting

Recommendations

- Add loading spinner or progress bar
- Show confirmation messages after actions

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

- Some terms are technical and hard to understand
- Icons are not familiar to users

Recommendations

- Use simple and common words
- Use recognizable icons and labels

3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

- No undo option for user mistakes
- Cancel or back button is not visible

Recommendations

- Add undo and redo features
- Make cancel and back buttons clear

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing.

Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

- Inconsistent layout and button styles
- Different design on some pages

Recommendations

- Use consistent colors, fonts, and buttons
- Standardize layout across all pages

5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

- Users can input invalid data
- No warning before deleting data

Recommendations

- Add input validation and required fields
- Add confirmation messages before delete

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

- Users need to remember steps
- Some labels are unclear

Recommendations

- Keep instructions visible
- Add labels and tooltips

7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts – hidden from novice users – may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

- No shortcuts for frequent actions
- No personalization options

Recommendations

- Add keyboard shortcuts
- Allow customization of features

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

- Interface looks crowded
- Too much unnecessary text

Recommendations

- Simplify layout
- Remove unnecessary elements

9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

- Error messages are unclear
- No solution provided

Recommendations

- Use simple and clear error messages
- Provide suggestions to fix errors

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

- No help section available
- No guide for new users

Recommendations

- Add help/FAQ section
- Provide tutorials or instructions

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Evaluator:
Maxin
Date:
Product:
Task

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

- Users are not notified during system processing
- Lack of feedback after completing actions

Recommendations

- Display loading animations while processing
- Add success notifications after actions are completed

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

- Some interface terms are difficult to understand
- Navigation labels are not user-friendly

Recommendations

- Use familiar and easy-to-understand terms
- Improve labels based on real-world language

3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

- Limited options to cancel actions
- Users cannot easily recover deleted data

Recommendations

- Add visible cancel and back options
- Provide recovery or restore features

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing.

Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

- Some pages use different button designs
- Inconsistent spacing and alignment

Recommendations

- Apply the same design style across all pages
- Maintain consistent spacing and formatting

5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

- System accepts incomplete information
- Users may accidentally perform risky actions

Recommendations

- Require complete fields before submission
- Add warning prompts before critical actions

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

- Important options are not always visible
- Users need to remember navigation paths

Recommendations

- Keep menus and options visible
- Add guide texts and field descriptions

7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts – hidden from novice users – may speed up the interaction

for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

- Frequent actions require many steps
- No quick-access features available

Recommendations

- Reduce steps for common tasks
- Add shortcut buttons for frequent actions

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

- Some screens contain excessive information
- Certain elements distract users

Recommendations

- Keep only necessary information visible
- Use a cleaner and simpler interface design

9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

- Error messages do not clearly explain problems
- Users are not guided on how to fix errors

Recommendations

- Provide understandable error messages
- Include instructions to solve the error immediately

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

- Limited user support inside the system
- Users may struggle without guidance

Recommendations

- Add built-in user instructions
- Include tutorials and help documentation

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Evaluator:
john Rey
Date:
Product:
Task

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

- System response is sometimes unclear
- Users do not know if processing is ongoing

Recommendations

- Provide real-time status feedback
- Add progress indicators during loading

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

- Some menu names are confusing
- Interface does not fully use familiar terms

Recommendations

- Use user-friendly wording
- Follow real-world naming conventions

3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

- Users may accidentally perform actions
- Navigation options are limited on some pages

Recommendations

- Add confirmation and cancel options
- Improve navigation controls

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

- Different button sizes appear on pages
- Design elements are not fully uniform

Recommendations

- Maintain consistent button styles
- Standardize interface appearance

5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

- Incorrect inputs are not immediately detected
- Risky actions can be performed easily

Recommendations

- Validate inputs before submission
- Add warning dialogs before important actions

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

- Some features are difficult to locate
- Instructions are limited in certain sections

Recommendations

- Make important features visible
- Add clear labels and instructions

7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts – hidden from novice users – may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

- Users repeat the same steps frequently
- System lacks efficiency tools

Recommendations

- Add shortcut functions
- Simplify repetitive tasks

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

- Some pages contain unnecessary details
- Layout appears crowded in certain sections

Recommendations

- Organize content properly
- Use a cleaner and simpler layout

9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

- Error notifications are too general
- Users are not informed how to fix mistakes

Recommendations

- Use detailed but simple error messages
- Suggest corrective actions for errors

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

- Users have limited access to guidance
- No quick help feature is available

Recommendations

- Add accessible help documentation
- Include in-system assistance and tutorials

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Evaluator:
Christian
Date:
Product:
Task

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

- Users are not immediately informed after actions
- Processing status is not always visible

Recommendations

- Show instant feedback messages
- Add loading and status indicators

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

- Some system labels are unfamiliar
- Certain terms may confuse users

Recommendations

- Use simple and understandable language
- Apply familiar real-world terms and symbols

3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

- Users cannot easily reverse actions
- Exit options are difficult to notice

Recommendations

- Add undo and cancel functions
- Make navigation and exit buttons visible

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

- Some interface elements are inconsistent
- Layout design changes between pages

Recommendations

- Use consistent design patterns
- Maintain uniform layout and formatting

5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

- Invalid entries are sometimes accepted
- Users can accidentally delete information

Recommendations

- Restrict invalid inputs
- Add confirmation prompts before deletion

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

- Users must remember procedures
- Important instructions are hidden

Recommendations

- Display instructions clearly on screen
- Keep important options visible at all times

7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts – hidden from novice users – may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

- Tasks require repeated manual steps
- No advanced navigation features available

Recommendations

- Add quick-access functions
- Improve efficiency through shortcuts

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

- Interface contains unnecessary elements
- Some sections look overloaded

Recommendations

- Remove unnecessary content
- Use a clean and organized design

9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

- Error messages lack clear explanation
- Recovery steps are not provided

Recommendations

- Use user-friendly error messages
- Provide solutions and recovery guidance

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

- Limited instructional support for users
- No built-in guidance for beginners

Recommendations

- Add user manuals or FAQs
- Provide help features inside the system

Heuristic Evaluation Workbook

Evaluator:
Angel Lito
Date:
Product:
Task

1

Visibility of System Status

The design should always keep users informed about what is going on, through appropriate feedback within a reasonable amount of time.

- Does the design clearly communicate its state?
- Is feedback presented quickly after user actions?

Issues

- System activities are not always updated in real time
- Users may be unsure if requests are processed successfully

Recommendations

- Add real-time notifications and feedback
- Display status messages after every action

2

Match Between System and the Real World

The design should speak the users' language. Use words, phrases, and concepts familiar to the user, rather than internal jargon. Follow real-world conventions, making information appear in a natural and logical order.

- Will user be familiar with the terminology used in the design?
- Do the design's controls follow real-world conventions?

Issues

- Some interface terms are system-centered instead of user-centered
- Icons and labels may not immediately match user expectations

Recommendations

- Use terms commonly understood by users
- Improve icon-label matching for better understanding

3

User Control and Freedom

Users often perform actions by mistake. They need a clearly marked "emergency exit" to leave the unwanted action without having to go through an extended process.

- Does the design allow users to go back a step in the process?
- Are exit links easily discoverable?
- Can users easily cancel an action?
- Is *Undo* and *Redo* supported?

Issues

- Users have limited recovery options after mistakes
- Some actions cannot be cancelled immediately

Recommendations

- Include undo, redo, and cancel features
- Provide easier navigation controls

4

Consistency and Standards

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, situations, or actions mean the same thing. Follow platform and industry conventions.

- Does the design follow industry conventions?
- Are visual treatments used consistently throughout the design?

Issues

- Some pages have different formatting styles
- Certain buttons and menus are inconsistent

Recommendations

- Follow one consistent design standard
- Use uniform styles for buttons, menus, and layouts

5

Error Prevention

Good error messages are important, but the best designs carefully prevent problems from occurring in the first place. Either eliminate error-prone conditions, or check for them and present users with a confirmation option before they commit to the action.

- Does the design prevent slips by using helpful constraints?
- Does the design warn users before they perform risky actions?

Issues

- Users can proceed with incomplete inputs
- Critical actions lack preventive warnings

Recommendations

- Add validation checks before submission
- Provide confirmation prompts for important actions

6

Recognition Rather Than Recall

Minimize the user's memory load by making elements, actions, and options visible. The user should not have to remember information from one part of the interface to another. Information required to use the design (e.g. field labels or menu items) should be visible or easily retrievable when needed.

- Does the design keep important information visible, so that users do not have to memorize it?
- Does the design offer help in-context?

Issues

- Users may forget steps during navigation
- Important features are not immediately noticeable

Recommendations

- Keep navigation options visible
- Add visual cues and instructional labels

7

Flexibility and Efficiency of Use

Shortcuts – hidden from novice users – may speed up the interaction for the expert user such that the design can cater to both inexperienced and experienced users. Allow users to tailor frequent actions.

- Does the design provide accelerators like keyboard shortcuts and touch gestures?
- Is content and functionality personalized or customized for individual users?

Issues

- The system lacks faster methods for repeated actions
- Users cannot personalize frequently used features

Recommendations

- Add shortcut and quick-access options
- Allow customizable user preferences

8

Aesthetic and Minimalist Design

Interfaces should not contain information that is irrelevant or rarely needed. Every extra unit of information in an interface competes with the relevant units of information and diminishes their relative visibility.

- Is the visual design and content focused on the essentials?
- Have all distracting, unnecessary elements been removed?

Issues

- Some interface sections contain excessive details
- Certain design elements reduce readability

Recommendations

- Simplify content presentation
- Improve spacing and visual organization

9

Help Users Recognize, Diagnose, and Recover from Errors

Error messages should be expressed in plain language (no error codes), precisely indicate the problem, and constructively suggest a solution.

- Does the design use traditional error message visuals, like bold, red text?
- Does the design offer a solution that solves the error immediately?

Issues

- Error prompts are too brief or unclear
- Users are not guided on correcting mistakes

Recommendations

- Provide descriptive error messages
- Include clear recovery instructions

10

Help and Documentation

It's best if the system doesn't need any additional explanation. However, it may be necessary to provide documentation to help users understand how to complete their tasks.

- Is help documentation easy to search?
- Is help provided in context right at the moment when the user requires it?

Issues

- Limited support materials are available for users
- First-time users may struggle with system functions

Recommendations

- Add comprehensive help documentation
- Include tutorials and onboarding guides